NINJAS STEM FOUNDATION

Community Program Operating Procedures

Step-by-step workflow for education, outreach, event delivery, and records

Policy ID	Approval status	Effective date
NSF-CP-05	Proposed; not adopted	To be established

1. Scope and control

This SOP implements the Foundation's authorized community programs, including Robotics Discovery, mentorship and demonstrations. It complements—not overrides—the operative Bylaws, Outreach Committee Policy, Youth Protection & Safety Policy, Financial Management Policy, Privacy Statement, Code of Conduct, and event/host-specific requirements.

Use NSF-CP-02 and its existing intake/plan forms for independent-team mentoring. The Program SOP does not turn an independent team into an NSF-operated team and does not establish a new admission, financial or corporate right.

The Board or person with a valid recorded delegation must approve the relevant program scope and commitments before work begins. This SOP does not validate older actions or create retroactive authority.

2. Roles and responsibility map

Role	Operational responsibilities
Board of Directors	Approves program priorities, budget and reserved commitments; oversees material risks and policy compliance.
Outreach Committee / coordinator	Handles host pipeline, contact records, drafts, outreach calendar, publicity routing and impact reporting within delegation.
Event Lead	Owns individual activity readiness, host confirmations, staffing, resource checklist, execution, incident escalation and final record.
Head Coach / educational lead	Owns delegated student instruction, role assignments, presentation readiness, compliance with student-centered competition rules.
Safeguarding lead / adults	Confirm screening, supervision, emergency plan, student permission and concerns route.
Treasurer / approver	Checks authority, budget, expense documentation, restricted funds, reimbursement, donations, sponsor benefits and reporting.
Secretary / records owner	Retains approvals, document versions, official correspondence and required corporate records.

3. Stage 1 – Receive and classify the inquiry

Record date, source, organization/contact, program requested, proposed date, venue, age range, expected attendance, capacity, equipment needs, relevant deadlines, cost or funding implications, media considerations, and special conditions. Use a standard inquiry number or project identifier.

Classify the request as NSF-operated public program, independently operated team mentorship, third-party event participation, outside speaker request, or a proposed new program. Each category may require a different agreement and approval route; do not imply approval from an initial inquiry.

4. Stage 2 – Determine fit and authorized scope

Check mission fit, current staff and student mentor capacity, educational value, program safety, suitability of location, logistics, funding, obligations, and actual host requirements. Request only relevant participant information; sensitive student details shall not be placed in an open outreach tracker.

The Program Lead should communicate "under review," "modified proposal," "approved subject to conditions," or "unable to accommodate" without making an unauthorized commitment. For an unfamiliar program type, consider licensing, insurance, venue screening and professional review before approval.

5. Stage 3 – Prepare an event plan and approval record

Prepare a program brief with: educational goals and agenda; age/capacity; host and Event Lead; supervising adults; student mentor roles; venue; equipment and safety plan; contingency/cancellation; media and publicity arrangements; budget/funding; approvals; event deliverables and expected outcome metrics.

If the activity includes a material contract, fee, grant condition, sponsor return benefit, equipment loan or other reserved financial action, submit it to the proper authorized decision-maker under the Bylaws and financial approval schedule. Record the exact decision and date; a collection of informal approvals is not automatically Board action.

6. Stage 4 – Prepare educational materials and public communications

Assign a student contributor, responsible coach, Committee coordinator and final authorizer as appropriate. Verify factual claims, names/dates, sponsor acknowledgments, program descriptions, external links, logo permissions and student media clearance. Distinguish student-generated content from adult organizational approval. Distribute only a controlled final version.

In student-led presentations, students should explain their own work rather than read or claim adult-created solutions that violate the relevant competition's student-centered policy. Where adults disagree over revisions, resolve the matter through adult coordination and the correct approval route.

7. Stage 5 – Confirm readiness before public announcement

- Host acceptance and venue conditions documented; date, time, parking, facilities and accessibility confirmed.
- Event Lead, staff and youth mentors assigned; applicable adult clearance and student permissions verified.
- Emergency contacts, check-in/pickup arrangement, safeguarding and tool-safety plan confirmed.
- Equipment inventory and transport plan checked; demonstrations safe and age-appropriate.
- Approved budget/expense authorization recorded; any restricted funds and sponsor obligations identified.
- Publicity text, registration mechanism and optional media permissions validated.
- Cancellation, rescheduling and backup contacts identified.

8. Stage 6 – Deliver and monitor the activity

At the start, confirm host contact, supervising adults, staff assignments, safety boundaries and equipment setup. Explain rules and learning objectives in language appropriate to participants. Maintain observable supervision, protect emergency exits and adapt activities to accessibility and participant needs.

Activities should prioritize student engagement and safe exploration rather than competition performance. For drop-in events, avoid treating crowd estimates as verified unique-person counts. If supervision becomes inadequate or an unexpected hazard arises, modify, pause or end the activity.

No volunteer shall circumvent reporting requirements; suspected child abuse, urgent threats or emergencies must be handled promptly through the appropriate external routes. Document significant incidents separately in restricted records.

9. Stage 7 – Close out and report

Within a practical period set by the approved program schedule, the Event Lead should submit a concise record identifying actual date, host, program format, age/grade audience, headcount method, activities completed, student mentor roles, volunteer hours, equipment condition, final costs, partner feedback, relevant photos/permissions and action items.

Use common definitions: "program delivered" means a completed distinct event or session; "unique students reached" requires a defensible way to avoid repeated counting; "attendance" means participation instances; "repeat partner" means a second or subsequent completed or confirmed collaboration as defined by NSF; "volunteer hours" exclude unrecorded guesses.

Finance records are coded by program/activity, expense type and funding source and reconciled to claims and receipts. The Outreach Committee compiles supported figures for Board reports and public impact materials.

10. Stage 8 – Follow-up and continuous improvement

Thank the host through an approved channel, respond to feedback, review accessibility and safeguarding lessons, identify repeat interest, and update the outreach tracker. For recurring engagements, reassess staffing and funding rather than assume the next event is automatically approved.

For independent-team mentorship, follow the separate plan's progress review and renewal process; reauthorization may be needed after the initial term. Maintain a record of changes, approvals and the currently operative version of each form.

11. Document security and auditability

The official working repository shall contain non-sensitive host information, approved documents, schedules, written commitments and deliverables. Keep completed student forms, emergency information, screening, individual evaluations, consent records and incident details in appropriately restricted systems.

Records subject to a preservation duty shall not be deleted because an event ended or access to a group chat changed. Relevant organization records in private accounts must be preserved and transferred appropriately without demanding unrelated personal passwords.

12. Program-specific checklists and effective date

The Board may authorize short program appendices (demonstration checklist, workshop stations, scrimmage risk review, mentor meeting, special event booth) that remain subordinate to these policies. No appendix may enlarge corporate authority or reduce mandatory safeguards.

This SOP takes effect only after valid adoption and does not retroactively determine earlier event, role, enrollment, financial or Board disputes.